



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Just like old times! It's so great to see you.



Learning Outcome

Describe rooms, homes and objects in buildings in common social and work situations.

Ask your partner:

- How often do you catch up with old friends? What do you talk about?

Can Do Statements

- I can use expressions to indicate the past.
- I can talk or report about actions, events or people.
- I can talk about what I used to do.





Let's Explore!

Vanessa and Sally catch up. Which city has **good vibes***?

* When a city has "good vibes" it is friendly and warm.



BOSTON

Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Vanessa: Thanks so much for letting me stay here, Sal.

Sally: Oh, no problem! Just like old times. It's so great to see you!

Vanessa: You, too! I got so excited when I was flying into the airport. The familiar Boston skyline reminded me of when I was a child. When I was in high school, I used to travel a lot with my soccer team. We flew to nearby cities to play in tournaments.

Sally: Wow - what a jet-setter you were! How was living in San Francisco? I remember visiting about 10 years ago, but I don't remember much.

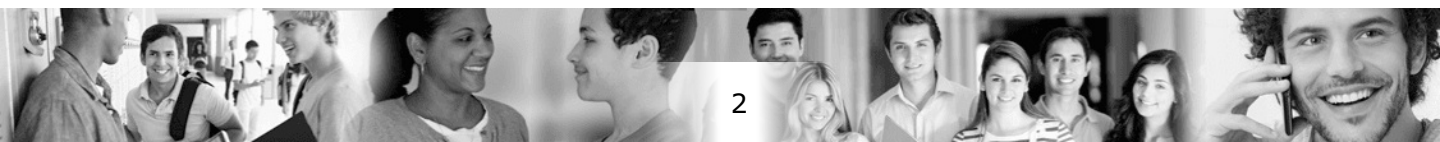
Vanessa: San Francisco is a really eclectic city. It has really good vibes - the people there are really liberal and open-minded.

Sally: Sounds amazing!

Vanessa: While I was living there, I finished cooking school and worked at the restaurant where I met Marco.

Sally: Marco ... what a guy! What a rollercoaster ride that relationship is!

Vanessa: For sure.





Let's Practice!

What a rollercoaster ride of a relationship we had last year!

Instructions: Choose all the correct answers.

1. Which sentences have past time expressions?
 - ☐ When I was a child, I used to travel a lot with my soccer team.
 - ☐ I went to Boston three years ago.
 - ☐ I am 22 years old.
 - ☐ She visited New York in 2005.
 - ☐ She was my best friend.



Let's Practice!

Let's report about past events!

Instructions: Read the sentences. Fill in the blank with the past tense of the bracketed word.

1. I (get) _____ excited.
2. I (finish) _____ cooking school.
3. I (meet) _____ Marco.
4. The skyline (reminds) _____ me of my childhood.
5. I (fly) _____ to other cities to play in tournaments.





Extension Activity

Listen to a song!

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Find the song "This Used To Be My Playground" by Madonna.
- Listen for all the examples of "used to".
- Find the lyrics online or at the library.
- Write down the example sentences using "used to".
- Share them with a partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I listen to "This Used to be my Playground".

☐ ☐

I write down examples of "used to".

☐ ☐

I share them with my partner.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **to let** (verb): to allow someone to do something
Example: Thank you for letting me stay at your house.
- **to stay** (verb): to remain in one place for some time
e.g. You can stay at my house when you visit.
- **tournament** (noun): a series of contests in a sport
e.g. I played in basketball tournaments in high school.
- **skyline** (noun): the outline of buildings against the sky
e.g. The Boston skyline is beautiful.
- **eclectic** (adjective): diverse; from many places, cultures
Example: San Francisco is a really eclectic city.
- **open-minded** (adjective): describing someone who is open to new ideas and people
e.g. The people in San Francisco are open-minded.
- **liberal** (adjective): open to new behavior or opinions
e.g. The people there are really liberal.





Learning Points

Past Time Expressions

There are many ways to refer to specific times in the past.

You use expressions like *three years ago* or *last year* when you talk about the past.

You use expressions like *in 2012* when you talk about a year in the past.

You use *When I was ...* to talk about a period of time.

Expression	Example
in ... (month or year)	<i>I went to Mexico in 2012.</i>
last ... (day, month, time, etc.)	<i>I visited my Aunt Nelly last year.</i>
(number of months or years) ... ago	<i>I bought my ticket 3 weeks ago.</i>
When I was ...	<i>I played in a basketball tournament when I was in high school.</i>

Examples:

- *I remember visiting San Francisco about 10 years ago.*
- *When I was in high school, I used to travel a lot.*

Talking About What You Used To Do

You use *used* to talk about things you usually did in the past but do not do anymore or to say that something was once true.

We write *use to* (without the d) in negative statements *and* questions.

Examples:

- *I used to travel a lot in high school.*
- *Did she use to use a personal shopper?*
- *What did they use to do in the summer?*
- *They didn't use to play piano.*

